

1944, June 8

The following is a faithful transcription of the typewritten original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

St. Bonaventure Monastery  
1740 Mt. Elliott Avenue  
Detroit, Mich.

June 8th, 1944.

Rev. M. E. Joachim Casey.  
Mt. Hope Baltimore, Baltimore.

My Dear Brother, Father Joachim:--

God bless you and yours-- my poor self I hope included. I received your letter yesterday and, while there is a silent note therein of dissatisfaction that I can hardly be surprized at or blame you for, yet I am more than pleased and I thank God for the wonderful progress you've made in what must, in my opinion, please Heaven better than all your success on the Rockey-Mountain Missions or at catechism in parishes or hospitals, etc. In other words, your profiting by the outstanding opportunity God himself, in His wisdom and mercy has been providing for you in the mill of humiliation.--"No humiliation, no humility; no humility, no real virtue." (S. Bernard). It's God and His holy grace more than anything else we ought thank that you, after three and thirty years in the Holy Priesthood, in the brunt of the "warfare, therefore, you can still cling to your motto: "NON NOBIS DOMINE NON NOBIS!" This we may say especially under your present circumstances to say--and to act what we proclaim to God: "Not to us O Lord! not to us, but to Thy Name be the glory given!"

About a year ago, on occasion of his 60th anniversary to the Priesthood, the renowned Pastor of Ironton, Ohio--outstanding writer and lecturer --Father Cotter, told of his saintly and venerated sister, then recently deceased, that when he had come into her presence after just hearing all kinds of laudations on occasion of his Jubilee ten years before, she exclaimed earnestly and honestly: "O James! How we ought thank God that for these fifty years He has never permitted you to give any real scandal!"

So, dear Brother Maurice, Fr. Joachim: do not blame poor Father Chaplain if he seems unduly exacting, etc. If he were not a conscientious priest he would hardly be in such an extremely trying position. For who can doubt that at least now